and shelters were destroyed. The Russians were holding the front lines. For every ten Russian divisions the Germans killed, another ten sprang up to meet them.

Because Germany, Italy and Japan had signed the Tripartite Pact, Stalin was unsure if Japan would aid Germany in attacking Russia. When Stalin learned that Japan would still honor the prior Soviet-Japanese Nonaggression Pact, he was able to redeploy his troops in the east to confront the Germans in the west. However, it was Russia's most powerful ally, ‘General Winter’, which changed Russia's fortunes. With pre-winter came the overwhelming downpours, which hampered the German advance. Vehicles became stuck in poorly maintained streets and mud played its own role. Hitler had clothed his troops in summer attire because he expected to win against the Soviets well before winter. His men did not fare well in the below-zero conditions and many became sick. There were limited therapeutic supplies not everyone could be cured. The morale of the army dissolved as the German soldiers suffered throughout the winter.

In September, part of the German forces encircled Leningrad. However, Hitler starved it into submission instead of bombing it. Each feline, rodent, and living creature was eaten. A paste was made into soup, which was then given to the inhabitants. Slowly, all sources of fuel ran out. The city suffered for 872 days until the 27th of January 1944. Roughly 1,000 civilians died from starvation and from the lack of fuel that was needed to protect against the winter. Some supplies came from the east over Lake Ladoga but they were not enough for everyone. It is recorded by some historians that many resorted to eating human flesh to survive.